

Employee Handbook & HR Policies

Company guidelines on working hours, leave, remote work, code of conduct, and onboarding

1. Working Hours & Core Collaboration Hours

Standard full-time business hours are 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM in your local time zone, Monday through Friday (40 hours per week). To support cross-functional collaboration while maintaining flexibility, Acme operates with core collaboration hours between **10:00 AM and 4:00 PM** local time. Employees are expected to be available for meetings and synchronous communications during these core hours. Flexible working schedules outside of core hours may be arranged with manager approval.

2. Attendance & Notification of Absence

Punctuality and consistent attendance are expected. If you will be unexpectedly late or unable to work due to illness or emergency, notify your direct manager and log your absence in the HR portal prior to your scheduled start time, or as soon as reasonably practicable.

3. Paid Time Off (PTO) & Leave Policy

Acme provides a comprehensive paid time off program to support employee well-being and work-life balance:

- **Vacation Days:** Full-time employees receive **15 days of paid vacation per year**, accrued monthly at a rate of 1.25 days per month worked. Up to 5 unused vacation days may roll over into the next calendar year.
- **Sick Leave:** Employees receive **10 paid sick days per year**, front-loaded on January 1 (or prorated upon hire date). Sick leave covers personal illness, medical appointments, and caring for immediate family members.
- **Paid Holidays:** Acme observes **11 standard paid company holidays** each year (New Year's Day, MLK Day, Memorial Day, Juneteenth, Independence Day, Labor Day, Thanksgiving Day & Day After, Christmas Eve, Christmas Day, and 1 Floating Holiday).
- **Parental Leave:** Up to **12 weeks of 100% fully paid parental leave** for all new parents following birth, adoption, or foster placement, eligible after 6 months of continuous service.
- **Bereavement Leave:** Up to 5 consecutive paid days off for the loss of an immediate family member.

4. Remote Work & Hybrid Workplace Policy

Acme operates under a hybrid workplace policy designed for balance and collaboration:

- **Hybrid Schedule:** Standard employees work **2 days in office and 3 days remote** per week. Designated in-office anchor days are determined by individual department leaders.
- **Home Office Reimbursement Stipend:** New full-time employees are eligible for a one-time **\$500 home office stipend** to purchase ergonomic monitors, chairs, desks, and peripheral accessories. Submit receipts via the expense portal within 60 days of hire.
- **Internet Subsidy:** Acme provides a monthly recurring stipend of \$50 towards home internet bills.

5. Code of Conduct & Workplace Standards

Acme is committed to fostering an inclusive, respectful, and safe work environment. Key principles include:

- **Anti-Harassment & Non-Discrimination:** Zero tolerance for any form of harassment, discrimination, or retaliation based on race, gender, sexual orientation, disability, age, or religion.
- **Confidentiality:** Employees must safeguard all proprietary corporate data, customer records, financial figures, and intellectual property.
- **Conflicts of Interest:** Employees must disclose secondary employment or commercial interests that could conflict with their duties at Acme.

6. Onboarding Checklist: First Day and Week 1

To ensure a seamless transition, complete the following onboarding tasks:

- **Before Your First Day:** Complete electronic I-9 employment verification, sign offer letter, and submit direct deposit banking details.
- **First Day:** Boot laptop, set up Okta MFA, configure corporate email, join Slack #general, and meet your onboarding buddy.
- **First Week:** Complete mandatory 30-minute Security Awareness Training, enroll in benefits (within 30 days), and complete 1-on-1 introductory meetings with your manager.

HR People Team Contact: For policy questions, leave requests, or workplace concerns, email hr-people@company.com.